

CS IGCSE Questions Compilation

Table of Contents

Practice with Random Questions

Problem Solving



Programming



Data



Computers



Communication and The Internet



The Bigger Picture



Topic 1: Algorithms

Chapter 1: Understanding Algorithms

▼ What is meant by an algorithm?

[1 mark]

An algorithm is a precise step-by-step method for solving a problem or completing a task.

▼ What is the difference between program and algorithm?

[2 marks]

An algorithm is simply a plan that contains a set of instructions to perform a specific task whereas a program is the coded version of one or more algorithms so that the computer can execute

▼ State why using flowcharts would be suitable to explain algorithms to non-technical people?

[2 marks]

Flowchart gives a visualized version of the algorithm making it easy to track down each step without needing any coding experiences/knowledges

Chapter 2: Creating Algorithms

▼ What is the difference between a constant and a variable

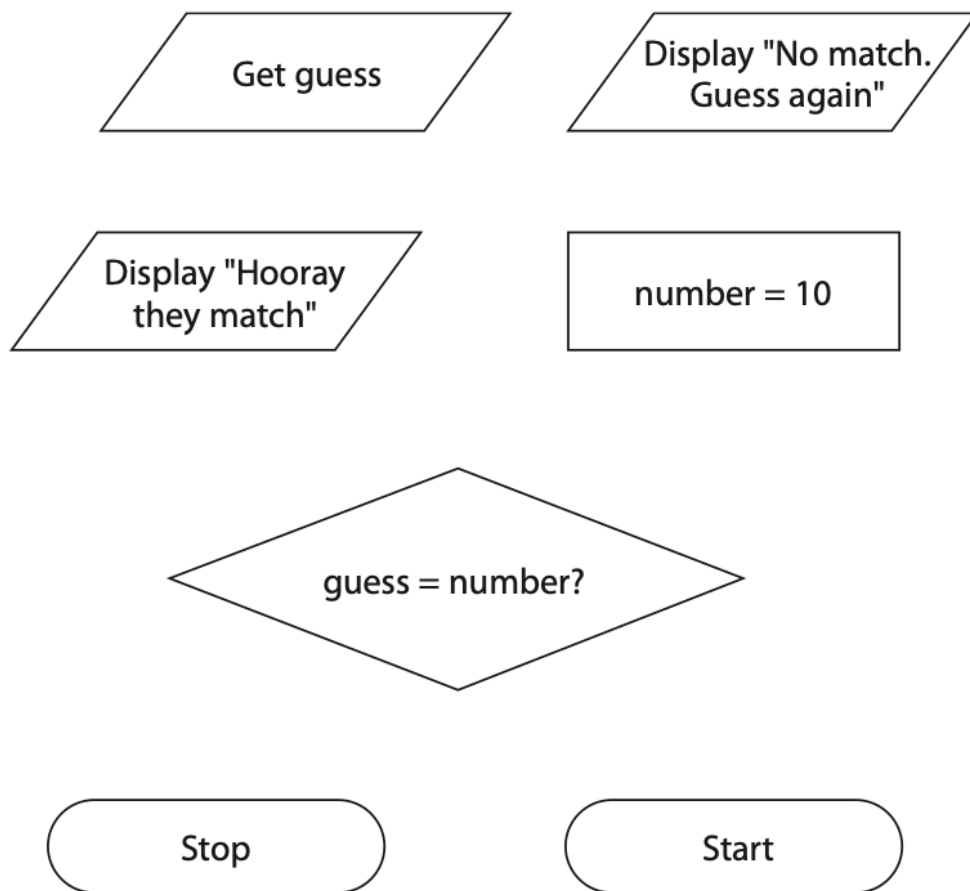
[1 mark]

A variable can change while a constant cannot

She is writing a guessing game.

She needs a flowchart to show the logic of the game.

(i) These are the components needed to draw the flowchart.



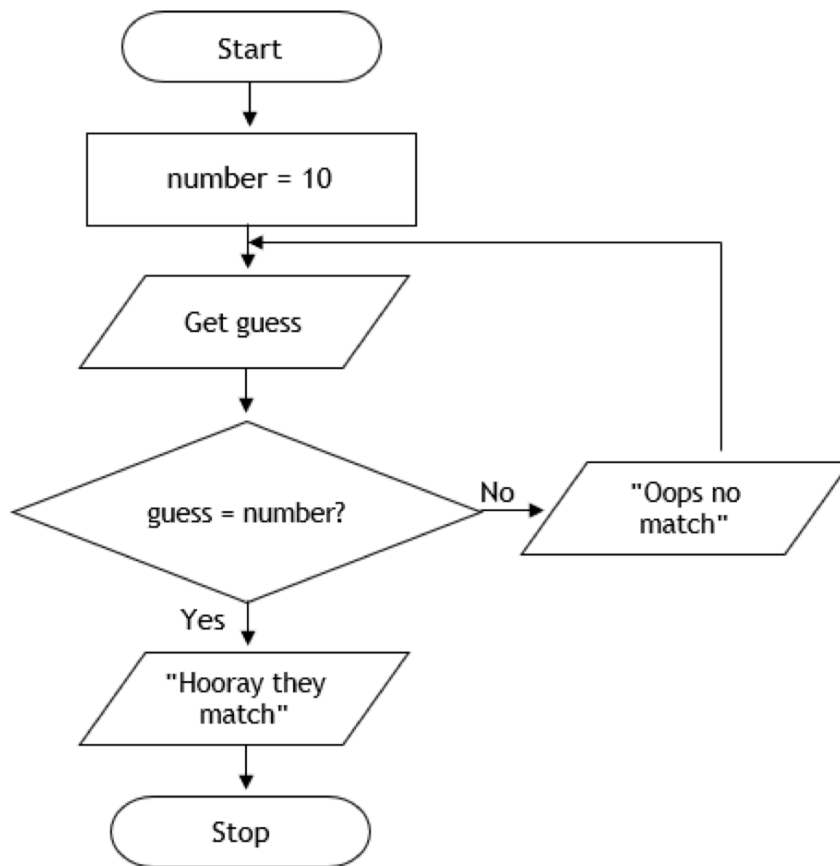
Draw the flowchart for the algorithm in the box on the next page.

Use each component once.

Do not add any additional components.

Use as many arrows and yes/no labels as you need.

(5)



5

Chapter 3: Sorting and Searching Algorithms

▼ Define recursion

[1 mark]

A process that is repeated again and again until the condition is met

▼ Define brute force

[2 marks]

An algorithm that doesn't have any techniques to improve performance, but relies on computing power to try all possibilities until the solution is reached.

▼ Define divide and conqueror

[2 marks]

An algorithm design that works by dividing a problem into smaller and smaller sub-problems, until they are easy to solve. The solutions are then combined to complete problem

▼ How does Linear search work?

[3 marks]

- Starts at the first item of the list
- Compare the current item with the searching item
- If they are same then stop, else move to the next item until the end of list is reached or the value is found

▼ How does Binary search work?

[4 marks]

- Select the median item of the list
- If median is equal then stops
- If median is higher, selects the left side of the list and repeat the first two steps
- If median is lower, selects the right side of the list and repeat the first two steps
- Repeat these steps until the search is found or all median items have been checked

▼ How does bubble sort work (ascending order)

[3 marks]

- Start at the beginning of the list
- Compare two adjacent values, if they are not in ascending order then swap
- if they are in ascending order then move on to next value
- Repeat these steps until there are no swaps in the whole pass

▼ How merge sort works

[4 marks]

- it recursively breaks down the array into smaller sub-arrays
- until each single value is separated
- then it sorts adjacent sub-arrays and merges the results
- repeat the process until all sub-arrays are combined into one sorted array

▼ State two benefits of using linear search algorithm

[4 marks]

- easy to understand/debug/implement
- memory efficient as in-place algorithm
- the array does not need to be sorted saving workload and computing power

▼ State two benefits of using binary search algorithm

[4 marks]

- better efficiency on large data sets
- less time complexity compared to linear search

▼ State two benefits of using bubble sort algorithm

[4 marks]

- memory efficiency due to being in-place algorithm
- suitable for small programs and data set

▼ A list is made up of the numbers 4, 1, 2, 6, 3, 5. Identify steps involved when sorting this list using a bubble sort algorithm

[2 marks]

- Pass 1: 1 2 4 3 5 6
- Pass 2: 1 2 3 4 5 6

Chapter 4: Decomposition and Abstractions

▼ Define abstraction

[1 mark]

The process of removing or hiding unnecessary detail and highlighting only main points

▼ Example of using abstraction in coding

[2 marks]

- Using API/libraries

```
class Car:
    def __init__(self, make, model):
        self.make = make
        self.model = model
        self._engine_on = False # Implementation detail (protected)
    def start_engine(self):
        """Starts the car's engine."""
        self._engine_on = True
        print("Engine started.")
    def stop_engine(self):
        """Stops the car's engine."""
        self._engine_on = False
        print("Engine stopped.")
    def drive(self, distance):
        """Drives the car for a given distance."""
        if self._engine_on:
            print(f"Driving the {self.make} {self.model} for {distance} miles.")
            # Complex internal logic for driving (not shown)
        else:
            print("Please start the engine first.")
```

- In the above code we just call the function `start_engine()` or `drive()` but we don't need to know how it works behind so it is essentially an example of abstraction which simply reduces complex information into essential ones.

▼ Define decomposition

[1 mark]

Breaking a problem down into smaller and more manageable parts, which are then easier to solve

▼ List two benefits of using decompositions

[2 marks]

- Smaller problems are easier to solve
- Each smaller problem can be solved independently of the others
- Smaller problems can be tested independently
- Smaller problems can be combined to produce a solution to the full problem

Topic 2: Programming

Chapter 5: Developing Code

▼ Common Data types

[4 marks]

- String ("hello", "world")
- Character ('a', 'A')
- Boolean (True, False)
- Real (1.02, 3.1415, 2.71828)
- Integer (1, 2, 3, 100, 2000)

▼ Implement Linear Search

[3 marks]

```
numbers = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7]
found = False
target = int(input("Enter a number:"))
while index < len(numbers) and not found:
    if num == target:
        found = True
if found:
    print("Found")
else:
    print("Not found")
```

▼ Implement Binary Search

[6 marks]

```
numbers = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7]
low = 0
high = len(numbers) - 1
found = False
target = int(input("Enter a number: "))
while low <= high and not found:
    mid = (low + high) // 2
    if numbers[mid] == target:
        found = True
    elif numbers[mid] > target:
        high = mid - 1
    else:
        low = mid + 1
if found:
    print("Found")
else:
    print("Not Found")
```

▼ Implement Bubble Sort

[6 marks]

```
unsortedArr = [4, 2, 6, 1, 3, 2, 8]
def bubbleSort(arr):
    for i in range(len(arr)):
        checked = False
        for j in range(len(arr) - i - 1):
            if arr[j] > arr[j + 1]:
                cache = arr[j]
                arr[j] = arr[j + 1]
                arr[j + 1] = cache
                checked = True
        if (not checked):
            break
    print(arr)
    return arr
bubbleSort(unsortedArr)
```

Chapter 6: Making Programs Easier To Read

▼ 4 Techniques For making codes easier to read

[4 marks]

Technique	Description
Comments	Comments should be used to explain what each part of the program does.
Descriptive Names	Using descriptive identifiers for variables, constants, and subprograms helps make their purpose clear.
Indentation	Indentations make it easier to see where code starts and finishes.
White Space	Adding blank lines between different blocks of code makes them stand out.

Chapter 7: Strings

▼ How to concatenate string in Python?

[1 mark]

```
str1 = "hello"
str2 = "world"
finalString = str1 + " " + str2
print(finalString)
```


▼ How to lowercase, uppercase string in Python?

[1 mark]

```
str1 = "hello"  
str2 = "world"  
str1 = str1.lower()  
str2 = str2.upper()  
print(str1 + " " + str2)
```

▼ How to extract characters from string (Case: extract 'cation' from 'education')

```
sampleString = 'education'  
extractedString = sampleString[3:9]  
print(extractedString)
```

▼ How to check if the some characters are in a particular string? (Case: Check string 'convert' in inputWord)

[2 marks]

```
print('convert' in input())
```

▼ How to separate "," from this string "1,2,3,4,5,6,7,8" and turn it into list? [2 marks]

```
sampleString = "1,2,3,4,5,6,7,8"  
print(sampleString.split(","))
```

▼ How to transverse a string?

[2 marks]

```
# Using Method 1: For index loop
sampleString = "sample"
for i in range(len(sampleString)):
    print(sampleString[i])
```

```
# Using method 2: For each loop
sampleString = "sample"
for letter in sampleString:
    print(letter)
```

Chapter 8: Data Structures

▼ Describe a record

[2 marks]

A data structure that stores a set of related values of different data types

Chapter 9: Input/Output

▼ Implement Range Check (case: make sure the number is between 1 and 10)

```
num = int(input("Enter a number"))
while num < 1 or num > 10:
    num = int(input("Enter a number again because number isn't
between 1 and 10"))
print("You have entered", num)
```

▼ Implement Presence Check (case: check whether username is empty or not)

```
username = ''
while username == '':
    username = input("Please enter username:")
print("Hello", username)
```

▼ Implement Look up Check (case: check whether an item is in array) [2 marks]

```
arrayForms = ['7AXB', '7PDB', '7ARL', '7JEH']
form = input("Enter a form:")
valid = False
index = 0
length = len(arrayForms)
while valid == False and index < length:
    if form == arrayForms[index]:
        valid = True
    index = index + 1
if valid == True:
    print("Valid Form")
else:
    print("The form you have entered doesn't exist")
```

▼ Implement Length Check (Case: Enter a string of length 8)

[2 marks]

```
binaryString = input("Enter a string of 8 bit binary: ")
while len(binaryString) != 8:
    binaryString = input("You must enter a length of 8 binary string: ")
print("Valid")
```

Chapter 10: Subprograms

▼ List two types of subprograms and difference between them

[2 marks]

- Function
- Procedure

▼ What is the difference between function and procedure

[2 marks]

Functions return a value after performing a specific task while procedures does not return a value after executing the code

▼ Define Local Variables

[1 mark]

Variables that are defined inside the subprograms and are accessible only in the subprograms created

▼ Define Global Variables

[1 mark]

Variables that are defined outside the subprograms and are accessible everywhere in the program

▼ List two benefits of using subprograms

[2 marks]

- Making bigger problems easier to break down (decompose) and code
- Allows team members to be able to work on different parts of a problem
- Makes the program easier to debug
- Makes programs more efficient as code is not duplicated

▼ What is meant by built in functions

[1 mark]

Functions that are provided by programming languages to perform common tasks

Chapter 11: Testing and Evaluation

▼ What is trace table and why do we use it?

[2 marks]

- A technique used to identify logic errors in algorithms
- As we work through all the steps, we can see what values variables hold at a specific step.

▼ Draw and complete a trace table for this algorithm with these columns

headings

[5 marks]

- length
- count
- index
- scores[index]

```
SET scores TO [45, 67, 34, 98, 52]
SET length TO LENGTH(scores)
SET count TO 0
FOR index FROM 0 TO length - 1 DO
    IF scores[index] >= 50 THEN
        SET count TO count + 1
    END IF
END FOR
```

LENGTH	COUNT	INDEX	SCORES [INDEX]
5			
	0		
		0	
			45
		1	
			67
	1		
		2	
			34
		3	
			98
	2		
		4	
			52
	3		

▼ Answer these questions about the code.

- State the name of a user-defined subprogram
- State the name of one built-in subprogram.
- State the names of one input parameter
- State the name of a global variable
- State the name of a local variable
- State the line number of the command that 'calls' the variable [6 marks]



```
1  def rectangle(leng, wid):
2      ar = leng * wid
3      per = (leng*2) + (wid*2)
4      return(ar, per)
5
6  length = int(input("Please enter the length"))
7  width = int(input("Please enter the width"))
8  area, perimeter = rectangle(length, width)
9  print(area, perimeter)
```

- rectangle
- print
- length or width
- length, width, area or perimeter
- ar or per
- 8

▼ Three types of Errors that occur when constructing an algorithm [3 marks]

Type of Error	Description
Logic Error	An error in algorithm that results in unexpected behaviour
Runtime Error	An error that occurs while the program is running. Common Example is ZeroDivisonError
Syntax Error	An error that occurs when the computer tries to run code that it cannot execute. Example is forgetting to close parenthesis

▼ Describe 3 Testing Validation Rules (Normal, Boundary, Erroneous datas)

Data	Description
Normal Data	Data that is within the limits of what is accepted by program. Example 7 chars password for validation rules that states password must be between 6 and 8 digits
Boundary Data	Data that is at the extreme limits of what is accepted by the program. Example if a rule is ≥ 75 and ≤ 100 for accepted values, boundary data are 75 and 100 (both accepted)
Erroneous	Data that will not be accepted. If validation rules state number is > 0 then erroneous data is -1

Topic 3: Binary

Chapter 12: Binary

▼ Explain why a programmer might prefer to use hexadecimal

[2 marks]

It can represent larger values with fewer digits compared to decimal or binary making it easy to understand and read

▼ Convert 0101 0001 into decimal form.

[1 mark]

81

▼ Convert 234 into binary form.

[1 mark]

1110 1010

▼ Convert 1101 0010 into hexadecimal form.

[2 marks]

- 1101 = 13 = D
- 0010 = 2 = 2
- 2D

▼ Convert 4FAD into binary form

[4 marks]

- 4 = 0010
- F = 15 = 1111
- A = 10 = 1010
- D = 13 = 1101
- 0010 1111 1010 1101

▼ Add 0011 1001 with 0110 0100.

[2 marks]

1001 1101

▼ Difference between logical shift and arithmetic shift

[2 marks]

Logical shifts are performed on positive binary numbers whereas arithmetic shifts are performed on negative binary numbers

▼ Perform logical left shift by two (+2) for 1001 0110.

[2 marks]

0101 1000

▼ Perform logical right shift by five (-5) for 0110 1001

[2 marks]

0000 0011

▼ Perform arithmetic shift left by three (+3) for 1101 0011

[2 marks]

1100 1100

▼ Perform arithmetic shift right by four (−4) for 1010 0101

[2 marks]

1111 1010

▼ Represent −83 with sign and magnitude method

[2 marks]

1101 0011

▼ Represent 0111 1011 with 8 bit two complement form.

[2 marks]

- flip: 1000 0100
- add 1: 1000 0101

▼ Represent −67 with 8 bit two complement form.

[2 marks]

- 67: 0100 0011
- flip: 1011 1100
- add 1: 1011 1101

▼ Define overflow error

[2 marks]

this condition occurs when a calculation produces a result that is greater than the computer can deal with or store. When this happens, the microprocessor is informed that an error has occurred.

▼ Explain why binary is used to represent data

[2 marks]

Binary can represent two states (1) because computer circuits use transistors which can either be on or off (1)

Chapter 13: Data Representation

▼ What is a bitmap image?

[2 marks]

A grid of pixels that uses unique binary codes for each color and has a fixed resolution

▼ What is a unit of resolution?

[1 mark]

pixels per inch

▼ What is a metadata

[1 mark]

A data that represents other data

▼ Give the impacts of increasing the sampling frequency. [2 marks]

- The analogue sound wave will be represented more accurately, and the fidelity/quality of the recording will be improved
- The file size will increase/ more data stored (as each sample takes up disk space)

▼ List two benefits of using ASCII encoding [2 marks]

- Simplicity and Easy to understand
- Memory Efficiency as it only uses 7 bits (standard ASCII)

▼ Explain why Unicode was developed [2 marks]

- Before Unicode, there were hundreds of different encoding systems, and no single encoding system could contain enough characters to represent all major languages
- Standard ASCII only provides 128 different patterns, which can't represent all major languages
- Unicode uses a minimum of 16 bits, so it can represent at least 2^{16} characters.
- Unicode has a very large number of characters that can represent all languages/ ASCII was developed for English

▼ List two factors that affect the fidelity of the sound [2 marks]

- Bit depth
- Sampling rate

▼ Explain how increasing sample rate improves the fidelity of the sound [1 mark]

More samples can be captured per second which allow computer to take more samples and more audio samples to be included.

▼ Explain how increasing bit depth improves the fidelity of the sound [1 mark]

With bigger bit depth, higher level of amplitude can be measured adding more details

▼ State how to calculate the file size of an audio file [1 mark]

$\text{sample rate(Hz)} \times \text{bit depth(bits)} \times \text{duration(seconds)} \times \text{channel(mono or stereo)}$

▼ Define pixel [1 mark]

the smallest point of a bit-map image that displays a single point of color

▼ Define image resolution [1 mark]

pixels width x pixels height

▼ State how to calculate the file size of an image

[1 mark]

pixels width x pixels height x bit depth

▼ Describe the steps taken to convert the analogue sound to a digital sound file

[5 marks]

- set the sample rate/parameters/bit-depth (1)
- sample (the analogue sound) (1)
- measure the sound amplitude/volume/frequency (1)
- give a (binary) value/number for each measurement (1)
- store data as sample rate and values / digital signals (1)

▼ Explain what is meant by colour depth.

[2 marks]

the number of bits that is used to encode each pixel

▼ How many bits does standard ASCII uses to represent character

[1 mark]

7 bits

▼ How many bits does extended ASCII uses to represent character

[1 mark]

8 bits

▼ How many bits does Unicode uses to represent character

[1 mark]

2 bytes or 4 bytes

Chapter 14: Data Storage and Compression

▼ Table of unit of data in computer from b to TB

[6 marks]

Name	Size
Bit (b)	A single binary digit
Nibble	4 bits
Byte	8 bits
Kilobyte (kB)	1000 bytes
Megabyte (MB)	1000 kilobytes
Gigabyte (GB)	1000 megabytes
Terabyte (TB)	1000 gigabytes

▼ Define compression

[1 mark]

Compression is reducing the the size of a file so that it takes up less space on secondary storage

▼ Explain why lossy compression cannot be used to compress text [2 marks]

Lossy compression permanently deletes the data during compression state. In text documents, missing words can make the content unclear or even unreadable

▼ Define Run-Length Encoding (RLE) [1 mark]

It is a lossless compression algorithm that is used for compression text documents

▼ Explain how Run-Length Encoding (RLE) works [2 marks]

It encodes the count of repetitions along with the character. For instance, "FFFASS" as "3F1A2S".

▼ State when Run-Length Encoding (RLE) might not be efficient [2 marks]

When the file doesn't have repeated characters, and so the file size increased.

▼ What is the difference between lossless compression and lossy compression

Lossless compression does not delete any data during compression state whereas lossy compression deletes some of the data to reduce the file size

▼ What is the advantage and disadvantage of using lossless compression

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Advantage	All the data can be recovered restoring original quality
Disadvantage	Takes longer time and more processing power due to complex algorithms

▼ What is the advantage and disadvantage of using lossy compression

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Advantage	It reduces the file more significantly compared to lossless compression
Disadvantage	Data is lost permanenely, it can not be recovered back

▼ Why quality decrease is acceptable when using lossy compression to convert audio and iamges? [2 marks]

Humans can only see certain ranges of colors and audio (20 – 20000 Hz). Thus removing them doesn't make that much of a difference to human's perception.

▼ What are some differences between kilobyte and kibibyte

[2 marks]

- Kilobyte is equivalent to 1000 bytes, whereas a kibibyte is equivalent to 1024 bytes (1)
- Kilobyte is equivalent to 103 bytes, whereas a kibibyte is equivalent to 210 bytes (1)
- Kilobyte is a base 10 measurement, whereas a kibibyte is a base 2 measurement (1)

Chapter 15: Encryption

▼ Why is Caesar Cipher easy to crack?

[2 marks]

It uses limited number of keys so it can be cracked by using brute force algorithm

▼ Define encryption

[1 mark]

The process of converting plain text into cipher text

▼ Write down the purpose of encryption

[1 mark]

To make data unreadable by unauthorized users

▼ State two types of encryption method

[2 marks]

- Asymmetric encryption
- Symmetric encryption

▼ Define asymmetric encryption

[2 marks]

Encryption method that uses two different keys to decrypt and encrypt the data

▼ Define symmetric encryption

[2 marks]

Encryption method that uses the same key to decrypt and encrypt the data

▼ List at least two benefits of asymmetric encryption and symmetric encryption

Asymmetric Encryption	• No need key-sharing • Better security as it uses different keys to encrypt and decrypt the data
Symmetric encryption	• Faster due to less complex calculations • Efficient for encrypting large set of data

▼ List at least two types of ciphers

[2 marks]

- Pigphen cipher
- Caesar cipher
- Vigenere cipher
- Rail Fence cipher

▼ Describe how Caesar cipher works

[2 marks]

It works by shifting the order of alphabets according to the key

Topic 4: Computers

Chapter 16: Machine And Computational Models

▼ Define sequential processing

[1 mark]

Process instructions step by step in order from step to finish

▼ Define parallel processing

[1 mark]

Uses multiple processors to computer multiple instructinos simultaneously

▼ Define multi-agent processing

[1 mark]

Separate tasks are processed by different systems (agents) to perform a particular function.

▼ What is the difference between parallel processing and multi-agent processing

[2 marks]

Parallel processing handles only one single task whereas multi-agent manages several tasks at the same time

Chapter 17: Hardware

▼ Explain why sequential programs might not run faster with multicore processors

[2 marks]

- Sequential programs can only run one process at a time.
- Thus even using multicore processors the program will not run faster as it cannot do parallel computing

▼ Identify differences between RAM and ROM

[4 marks]

- RAM is volatile whereas ROM is non-volatile. Data stored in RAM get lost when the computer is turned off but data is kept in ROM after power-off.
- The size of RAM can be upgraded. However, the size of ROM can be not increased typically.
- RAM stores currently used data while ROM stores data necessary for booting up computer like BIOS.

▼ Two types of items stored in Von Neumann Architecture

[2 marks]

- Data
- Instructions

▼ What is a stored program concept?

[2 marks]

- A computer in which instructions and data are stored in same memory
- and are executed sequentially

▼ Explain how virtual memory works

[2 marks]

- Virtual memory (VM) is used when RAM becomes full (1) (to hold all programs and data).
- Virtual memory is used as (an extension to) main memory/RAM / works like RAM. (1)
- Virtual memory is stored/created on (internal) secondary storage/HDD/SSD. (1)
- Virtual memory is used as temporary storage. (1)
- Instructions and data not currently being used are transferred from RAM to VM/HDD. (1)
- When needed again, instructions and data are transferred back to RAM. (1)

▼ how does HDD work?

[3 marks]

- Made up of several metal discs coated with magnetic materials (Platters)
- Platter is divided into sector and tracks
- Each iron particles on platter are magnetized to represent 1 or 0 using read/write head

▼ How does SSD work?

[3 marks]

- Uses electronic circuits that can store binary values (1 or 0)
- Uses NAND/NOR flash memory to persistently control electron flow
- Applies high voltage to trap electrons in the floating gate (data storage)

▼ How does an optical drive work?

[2 marks]

- Uses a disc with a polycarbonate surface layer
- A laser beam reads/writes data by targeting the disc surface
- Creates physical pits (indentations) and lands (flat areas) on the disc
- Pits represent binary 0, lands represent binary 1

▼ What is the function of the Program Counter (PC)?

[1 mark]

Stores the address of the next instruction to be fetched.

▼ What does the Memory Address Register (MAR) hold?

[1 mark]

Stores the address of the instruction/data to be fetched from memory.

▼ Describe the role of the Memory Data Register (MDR).

[2 marks]

- Stores the data fetched from memory.
- Transfers this data to the Arithmetic Logic Unit (ALU) for execution.

▼ What is the purpose of the Current Instruction Register (CIR)?

[1 mark]

Stores the instruction currently being decoded by the CPU.

▼ State the function of the Accumulator.

[1 mark]

Temporarily holds the results of calculations performed by the ALU.

▼ How does Program Counter store the next address?

[2 marks]

- Holds the memory address of the next instruction to be executed
- Increments after each fetch cycle

▼ Define address bus

[1 mark]

The bus that carries memory address which connects MAR to Memory (RAM)

▼ Define data bus

[1 mark]

The bus that carries data value stored in a specific memory address which connects Memory to MDR

▼ Define control bus

[1 mark]

The bus that carries control signals connects from Control Units to other components

▼ State the effects of increasing width of addresses bus

[1 mark]

More memory addresses can be carried at a time

▼ State the effects of increasing width of data bus

[1 mark]

Bigger size of instruction can be carried per cycle

▼ Define cache

[2 marks]

- Cache stores frequently used data by CPU
- To speed up the processing
- As it is located near CPU

▼ List three factors that affect the performance of the CPU

[3 marks]

- Clock speed
- Number of cores
- Cache size
- Bus width

▼ Define clock speed

[1 mark]

The clock speed measures the number of fetch-decode-execute cycles that can take place in 1 second.

▼ State how increasing clock speed affect the performance of the CPU

[1 mark]

When clock speed is increased, more instructions can be executed per second reducing loading time and increasing computing power

▼ State how increased number of cores affect the performance of the CPU

Better parallel processing as more tasks are executed by different cores

▼ Explain why increasing clock speed can be bad for computer?

[2 marks]

- Increasing clock speed increases number of fetch decode execute cycles per second
- This leads to computer heating up drastically

▼ List two benefits of increasing computing power

[2 marks]

- Improve multi-tasking
- Reduce loading time

▼ List two disadvantages of increasing computing power

[2 marks]

- Higher cost due to better quality
- Higher energy consumptions leading to environmental impacts
- Higher heat generation causing electrical components burns or even melts

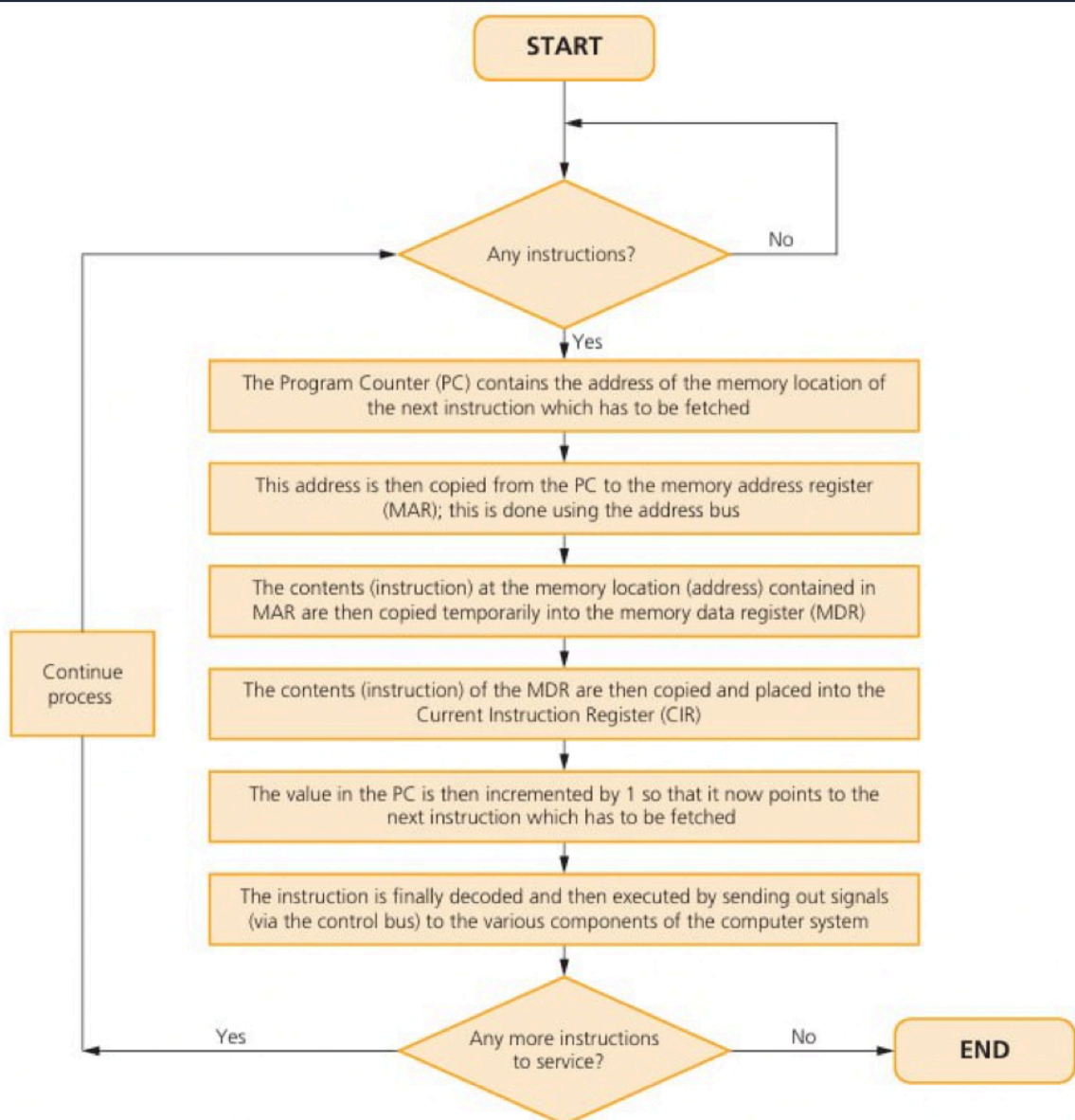
▼ Explain how increasing the size of the cache improves the CPU's performance.

Caches store frequently used data or instructions to reduce the need to access slower RAM. Since cache is faster and closer to the processor, it speeds up processing by minimizing wait times.

▼ Describe how fetch stage works in fetch-decode-execute cycle

[6 marks]

- The Program Counter (PC) holds the address/location of the next instruction to be fetched [1]
- The address held in the PC is sent to the Memory Address Register (MAR) [1]
- The memory address is sent using the address bus [1]
- The Program Counter is incremented [1]
- The instruction is sent from the address in memory to the Memory Data Register (MDR) [1]
- The instruction is transferred using the data bus [1]
- The instruction is sent to the Current Instruction Register (CIR) [1]



▲ Figure 3.3 Fetch-Decode-Execute cycle flowchart

▼ Which bus is uni-directional?

[1 mark]

Address Bus

▼ Discuss the benefits and drawbacks of using cloud storage.

[6 marks]

Benefits

- **Accessibility:** Access files from any location with WAN connectivity, collaborate in real-time with permission controls, and device-agnostic access (any internet-enabled device).
- **Scalability:** Flexible storage capacity adjustments (pay-as-you-grow).
- **Reliability:** Redundant server backups minimize data loss risks.
- **Cost Efficiency:** Reduces local hardware/staff costs (provider-managed IT).

Drawbacks

- **Security Risks:** Potential for external breaches or unauthorized access, and jurisdictional challenges in data protection laws.
- **Dependency:** Requires consistent high-speed internet and reliance on the provider's service continuity.
- **Hidden Costs:** Recurring subscription fees and potential overuse charges for bandwidth/storage.
- **Environmental Impact:** High energy consumption for servers and cooling.

▼ Describe an embedded system

[2 marks]

Embedded system is a combination of software and hardware (1) that is designed specifically to tackle a specific problem. (1) For example, usage in washing machine.

▼ Define truth table

[1 mark]

A table showing all possible combinations of the inputs and outputs of an operator.

Chapter 19: Software

▼ What is an application software?

[2 marks]

Software that is designed to perform specific task for the user. For instance, word processing software, photo editing software, etc

▼ The operating system controls the scheduling of processes. Describe how the operating system uses scheduling to allocate processor time

[4 marks]

- All processes are held in a queue
- Processes are prioritised
- Processes are allocated time slices
- Length of time slice depends on priority
- (and) processes are switched (at the end of their time slice)
- Unfinished processes are put to the back of the queue
- During the time slice the process has exclusive use of the processor

▼ Describe how an operating system manages the storage of a file on random-access secondary storage. [4 marks]

- OS checks whether there is space on disk
- The file is broken into blocks
- Blocks are stored in any spaces that are large enough to store each block
- Blocks can reside anywhere on the storage
- Meta data about file is created and separately stored

▼ List at least 4 functions of Operating Systems [4 marks]

- Providing User Interface
- User management
- Hardware management
- File management
- Process management
- Resource management
- Memory management
- Print Spooling

▼ State 2 differences between Graphical User Interface and Command Line Interface [2 marks]

- A Command Line Interface (CLI) requires users to interact with the operating system using text based commands
- A Graphical User Interface (GUI) requires users to interact with the operating system using visual elements such as windows, icons, menus & pointers (WIMP)

▼ What is scheduling?

[2 marks]

The algorithm that the OS uses to share a portion of CPU time to each programs which are currently running

▼ What is paging?

[2 marks]

The algorithm that the OS uses to move programs from RAM to disk and back again when needed once main memory is full

▼ Why do users need back-up?

[2 marks]

To protect against loss of data from

- natural diseases
- Hardware failure
- Cyberattacks

▼ A restaurant has a computer-based ordering system which is running slowly. A technician has said that the hard disfragmented. The technician has suggested using utility software to defragment the drive.

[4 marks]

- Orders have been saved onto the system as they order food and then deleted once processed (1)
- Once other orders have been made, new files are created (1) which may be bigger than the spaces left by the deleted files (1)
- The order files are split up (1)

▼ Explain how defragmentation software could overcome the issue of the slow computer system. [3 marks]

- Files on the hard disk drive are moved (1)
- Empty spaces collected together (1)
- Files are moved to be stored together (1)
- Fewer disc accesses are needed (1)

▼ Define 'What if' questions [2 marks]

running a computer model with a given set of inputs to see what the model produces as an output or prediction

▼ Explain one problem using simulation to predict the effect of changes

- If the data is incomplete/inaccurate (1) the answers from the model might not be right (1)
- If the assumptions the model is based on are inaccurate (1) the answers from the model might be incomplete/inaccurate (1)

▼ Describe how the operating system enables processes to share a single CPU. [1 mark]

- The operating system uses a scheduler to control processes (1)
- The operating system holds processes in a queue (1)
- Some processes may be given higher priorities than others (1)
- Each process gains accesses to the CPU for a short time / time slice to execute (1)
- Processes are swapped to/from (the queue / CPU)

Chapter 20: Programming Languages

▼ What is a low level programming language? [1 mark]

The language that is closer to machine code (binary)

▼ What is an instruction set? [1 mark]

Something that tells CPU what to do

▼ Why is writing code in assembly challenging? [3 marks]

- A very limited range of instructions available
- Have to manage all data and decide how to store them in memory manually
- Debugging is challenging and can make machine crash

▼ Compare characteristics of high-level languages and low-level languages

1

High Level Languages	Low Level Languages
One instruction of high level code represents many instructions of machine code	One instruction of assembly code only represents one instruction of machine code
The same code will work for many different machines and processors	Usually written for specific machine and won't work on others
Code is easy to read, understand, and modify	Code is very difficult to read, understand, and modify
Don't have much control over CPU can do so programs are less memory efficient	Full control of CPU and can use memory wisely to make programs more efficient
Programmer can easily store data in lots of different structures	Programmer needs to know about internal structure of CPU and how it manages the memory.

▼ Identify 3 features that IDE might be used when programming

[3 marks]

- Run time Environment
- Editor (any feature such as auto-correct, auto-indent)
- Translator
- Version Control
- Breaking points
- Stepping

▼ Compare four features between a compiler and an interpreter.

[4 marks]

Feature	Compiler	Interpreter
Execution	Translates entire code into machine language before execution.	Translates and executes code line-by-line.
Speed	Faster execution (pre-compiled).	Slower (translates during runtime).
Error Handling	Reports all errors after compilation.	Stops at the first error encountered.
Portability	Output is machine-specific (less portable).	Code can run on any machine with the interpreter (more portable).

Topic 5: Networking

Chapter 21: Networks

▼ Define network

[1 mark]

A network is formed when two or more devices are connected each other

▼ What is a network protocol?

[1 mark]

A set of rules for communication

▼ Why do people connect to network?

[2 marks]

- To share access to the internet/WWW/broadband connection
- To enable internal communication using email, instant messaging, and calendar
- To share files/data across multiple devices
- To share peripherals like printers and other hardware

▼ List three types of network and define each one

[3 marks]

LAN	A network that covers a small geographical area
WAN	A combination of networks (LANs) that covers a large geographical area
PAN	A short-range network that forms near a single user connecting personal devices

▼ Write the difference between LAN and WAN

[2 marks]

- LAN only covers a small geographical area whereas WAN covers a large geographical area
- LAN is a single network but WAN is a collection of networks(LANs)
- LAN is typically home network or owned by single organization. However, WAN is usually owned by multiple organizations

▼ Define server

[1 mark]

A powerful computer that provides services to other computers (clients) connected to the network

▼ Define client-server network model

[1 marks]

A network that has at least one server to provide services to the client computers.

▼ Define peer-to-peer network model

[1 marks]

A network that does not have any dedicated servers. Each device can act as both client and server.

▼ Write the difference between client-server and peer-to-peer network [2 marks]

In client-server network, all devices are connected to the server whereas there is no centralized device in peer-to-peer network.

▼ List features of client-server and peer-to-peer network

[6 marks]

Field	Client-server	Peer-to-peer
Performance	Usually high performance when the server is not drained	Depends on the number of devices connected as the network load is shared between nodes
Centralization	Has at least one centralized server	Does not have any centralized servers. All devices have equal access on files and resources
Security	Can perform centralized patches/updates and reinforces user authentication	Usually not secure as peers can distribute malware easily
Maintenance	Easy of maintenance as network is centralized	Hard to maintain the network as each peer/node is independent
Scalability	Easy to add new devices but might need additional server upgrades due to increased loads	Easy to add new devices without affecting the performance of the network
Reliability	Services/Resources is not available when server goes down unless there are backup servers	Other nodes/devices can still contribute the resources even when the device disconnect
Privacy	Has Privacy concerns as servers can monitor, spy and keep logs of the clients	Hard to track or identify peers on the network as there is no centralized device

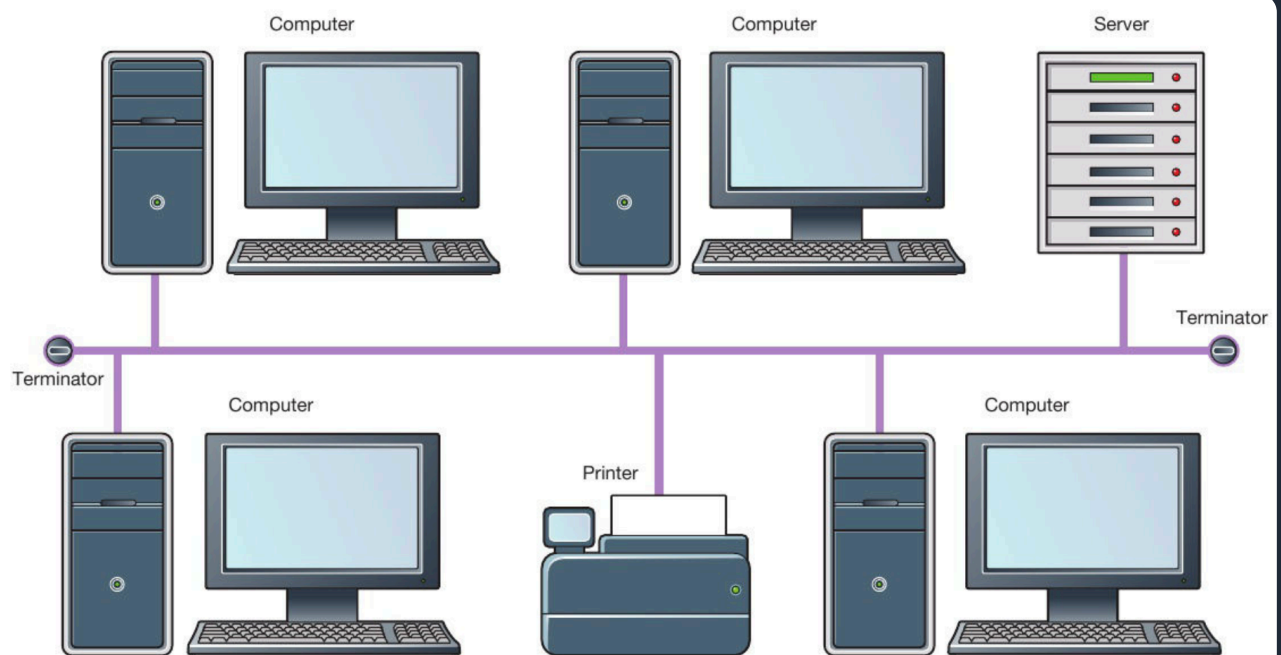
▼ Describe what is meant by the term Ethernet®.

[2 marks]

- A protocol (suite/group/family) (1)
- Used on a wired network / wired connection (1)
- Defines physical parts/type of cable (twisted pair, CAT6)/type of connector (1)
- Defines how packets are checked for errors (1)
- Defines the speed of transmission (1)
- Operates at the link layer of the TCP/IP stack (1)

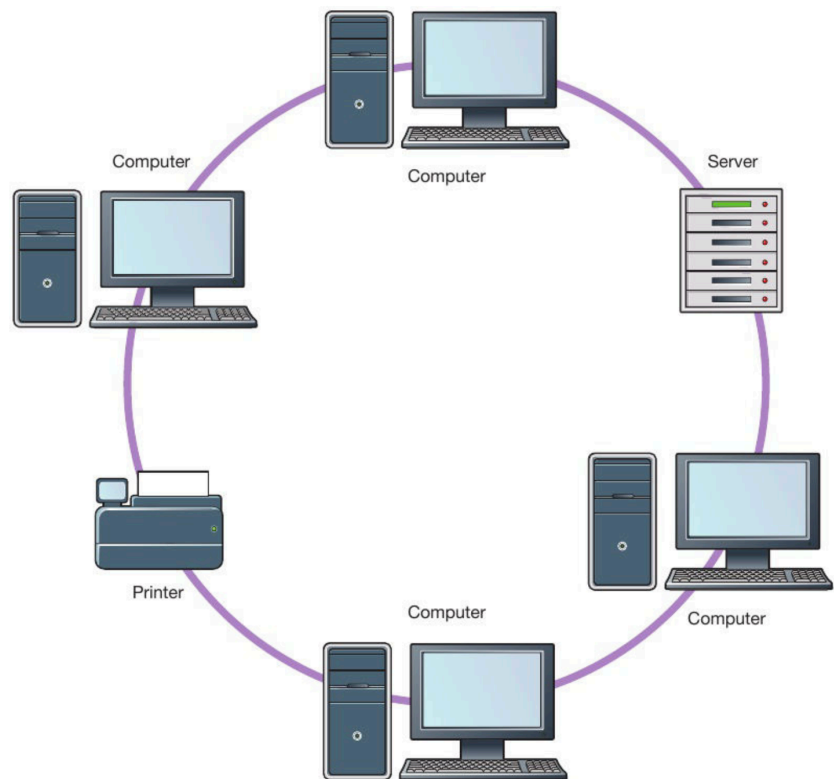
▼ Draw A Bus Topology

[4 marks]



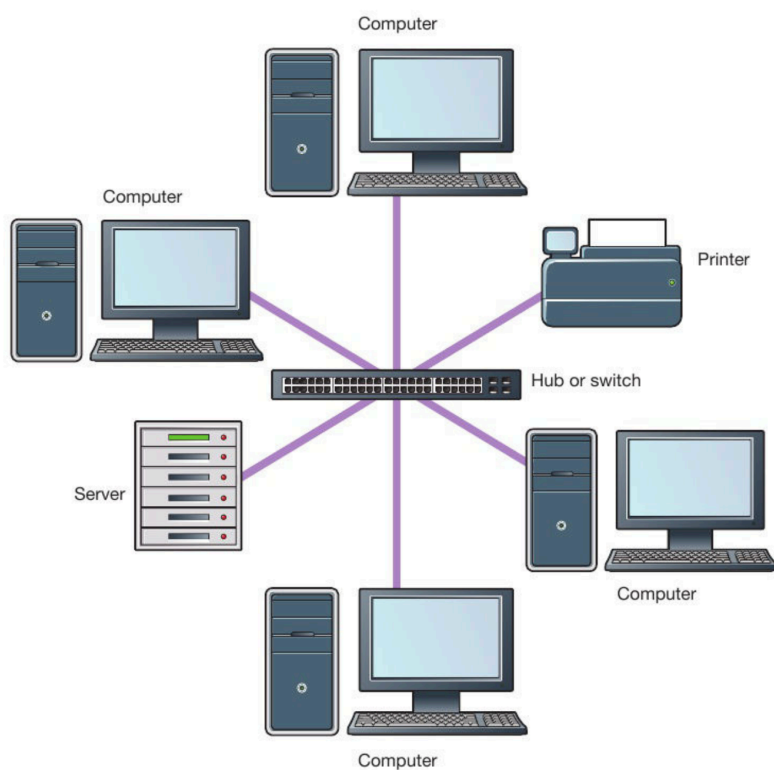
▲ Figure 5.2 Bus network topology

RING



► Figure 5.3 Ring network topology

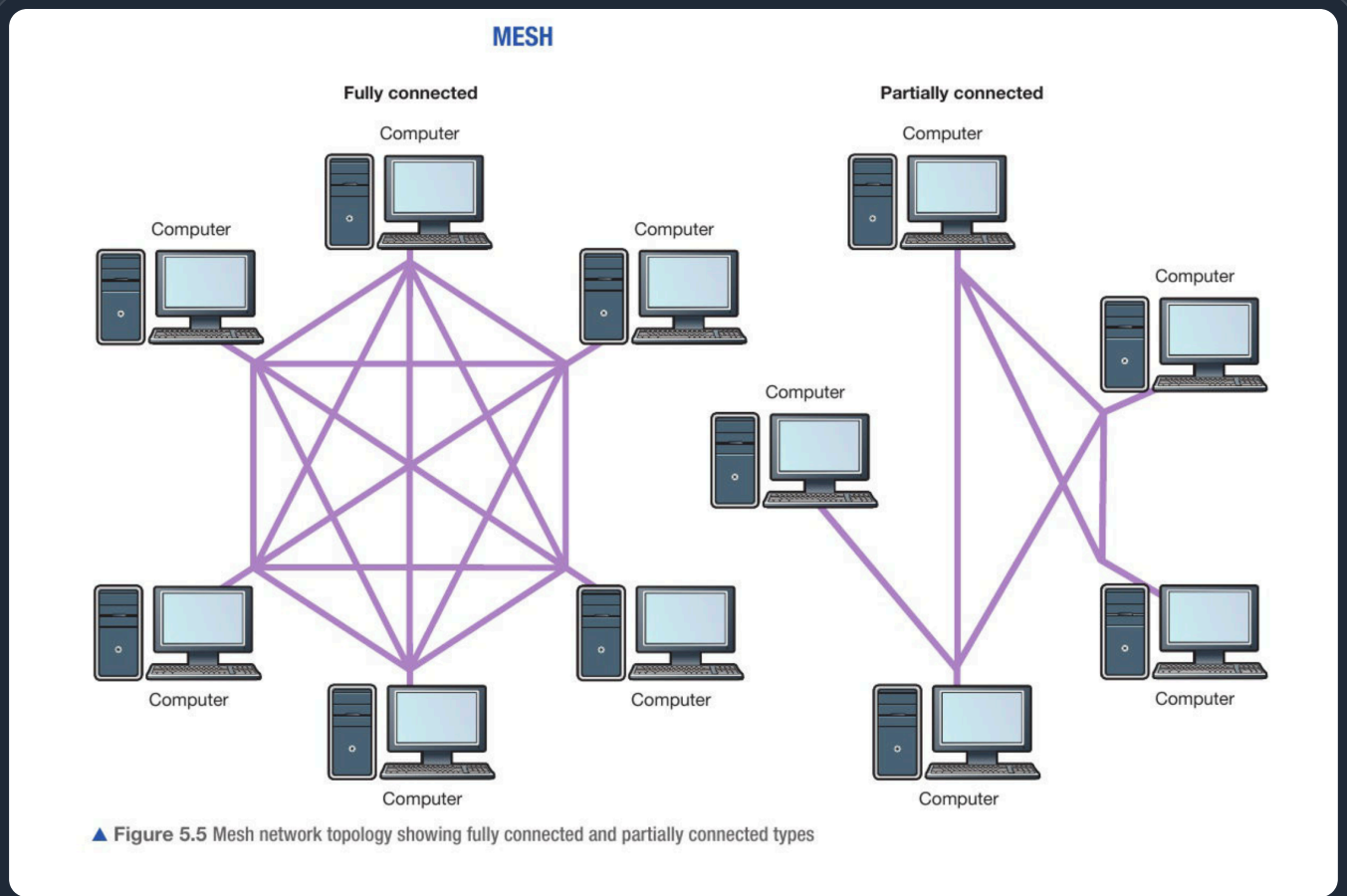
STAR



► Figure 5.4 Star network topology

▼ Draw A Mesh Topology

[4 marks]



▼ Describe advantages and disadvantages of Bus Topology

[3 marks]

Advantages

- Easy to install
- Cheap cabling cost compared to star and mesh
- Easy to add new devices

Disadvantages

- Not secure
- Hard to find faults
- Single Failure Point (main cable/terminator)
- Poor Performance due to data collisions

▼ Describe advantages and disadvantages of Ring Topology

[3 marks]

Advantages

- less cabling compared to other topologies
- no data collisions as data flow in only one direction

Disadvantages

- hard to add new devices
- hard to find faults
- single failure point

▼ Describe advantages and disadvantages of Star Topology

[3 marks]

Advantages

- Easy to connect/ remove new nodes
- Failure of one node/link does not affect the rest of the network
- Easy to detect the failure of one node/link

Disadvantages

- If the central switch/hub fails, then the whole network fails
- Performance and the number of nodes that can be added depend on the capacity of the central switch/hub
- Can require more cable than some of the other topologies

▼ Describe advantages and disadvantages of Mesh Topology

[3 marks]

Advantages

- High performance
- High fault tolerant

Disadvantages

- Excessive cabling
- Expensive
- Hard maintenance

▼ List four layers of TCP/IP protocol stack and write function of each layer

[4 marks]

Application	• provides an user interface interacting with the user • hosts the application layer protocols such as email protocols
Transport	• provides an end-to-end communication between devices • breaks down the data into packets • adds packets number in packets headers
Internet	• Adds source IP address and destination IP address
Data link	• connects with physical components

▼ How does TCP protocol work?

[4 marks]

- It specifies the receiving computer sends acknowledgements that each section of the data sent has been received
- Using checksums to ensure that the data received is accurate
- Allowing the receiving computer to tell the sending computer to slow down transmission.
- Ensuring data sent up to application layer contains no duplicate and is in correct order.

▼ List two protocols that work in application layer and function of each protocol

Protocol	Description
HTTP (Hyper-text Transfer Protocol)	Used for transferring html documents
HTTPS (Hyper-text Transfer Protocol Secure)	The same as HTTP but uses encryption to be more secured
FTP (File Transfer Protocol)	Used for transferring files
SMTP (Simple Message Transfer Protocol)	Used for sending emails to mail servers and between mail servers
POP3 (Post Office Version 3) and IMAP (Internet Message Access Protocol)	Used for receiving and reading emails from mail servers

▼ List three email protocols

[3 marks]

- SMTP
- IMAP
- POP3

▼ What is the difference between POP3 and IMAP

[2 mark]

POP3 downloads the email to the user local storage. Once the file is downloaded, it deletes on the mail server; however IMAP keeps the email on mail server thus allowing different devices to sync.

▼ Function of DNS server

[2 marks]

To give the corresponding IP address of domain name to the web browser

▼ Describe the process of accessing a web page

[4 marks]

- domain name or URL is entered to the search bar
- browser connects to the DNS server
- DNS gives corresponding IP address of the domain name
- browser connects to the web server using that IP address
- requests the web page
- if the request is successful, web page is transferred to the browser
- browser displays it

▼ List two examples of wireless connectivity

[3 marks]

- Wi-Fi
- Bluetooth
- Infra-red

▼ List ways to identify devices on the network

[3 marks]

- Device name
- IP address
- MAC address

▼ What are the differences between IP addresses and MAC addresses [2 marks]

- IP address is dynamic/can change // MAC address is static/cannot change [1]
- IP address is used to communicate on a WAN/Internet // MAC address is used to communicate on a LAN [1]

▼ Compare three features between wired and wireless connectivity. [6 marks]

Feature	Wired	Wireless
Speed	Faster data transmission (e.g., fiber optic cables)	Slower due to signal interference
Security	Harder to intercept (physical access required)	Requires encryption to prevent eavesdropping
Installation	Expensive/cumbersome (cables, ports)	Flexible but prone to interference (walls/devices)
Portability	Not portable due to cabling hazards	Ultimate portability within the WAP range

▼ State two types of connectivity media for wired communication [2 marks]

- Copper wire
- Optical fibre

▼ Write down the function of the switch [2 marks]

- Switch connects devices and transfer data within a LAN.
- It does this by looking at destination MAC address and forwarding to the correct port to the intended device using the MAC address table.

▼ Write down the function of the modem

[2 marks]

Modem is a device that converts digital signals to analogue signals and vice versa

▼ Describe how a router directs data on the internet

[5 marks]

- Reads the data/packet to find the recipient's address (1)
- Has physical connections to ≥ 2 different networks (1)
- Holds a routing table (1)
- Stores information about (IP) addresses (1)
- Keeps packets inside a network by not forwarding them (1)
- Forwards data / directs/forwards/sends packets (1) [Not 'directs data' as in question]
- Chooses the most efficient path to the next node (1)

▼ Identify the radio frequency used by smartphones to connect to Wi-Fi [1 mark]

- A 2.4 GHz
- B 3 KHz
- C. 4.1 GHz
- D 5 KHz

A 2.4 GHz

▼ Why do we use TCP/IP protocol suite?

[2 marks]

- It makes the overall model easier to understand by dividing it into functional parts.
- Each layer is specialized to perform a particular function.
- The different layers can be combined in different ways.
- One layer can be developed or changed without affecting the other layers.
- It makes it easier to identify and correct networking errors and problems.
- It provides a universal standard for hardware and software manufacturers to follow.

Chapter 22: Network Security

▼ Define authentication

[2 marks]

The process of verifying someone's identity

▼ Define validation

[2 marks]

The process of checking whether data fits in certain requirements or rules

▼ Define Social Engineering and three types of it

[6 marks]

Social Engineering	Exploiting the human behaviour / faults to steal sensitive / confidential information
Phishing	Process of tricking the user to enter their personal information themselves. Attackers pretend to be from legitimate / original source
Pharming	Process of redirecting the user to fake website by poisoning DNS server or browser DNS setting
Shoulder Surfing	• A hacker / third party spies on / watches the user (of an electronic device) (1) • In order to obtain their personal identification number / password / login information / sensitive information (1)

▼ Explain ways to protect against Phishing, Pharming and Shoulder Surfing

Phishing	• enabling email spam • not clicking suspicious/malicious links • keeping up to date with latest anti-malware software
Pharming	• using secure DNS provider • looks for HTTPS protocol in site URL
Shoulder Surfing	• shield your screen/keypad/keyboard when entering (sensitive/personal) information (1) • to stop people seeing/memorising passwords/named sensitive item/sensitive/personal information (1)

▼ Define malware

[2 marks]

Any software that has malicious purpose/code to get unauthorized access or steal sensitive/personal/confidential information

▼ List three types of malware

[3 marks]

- virus
- worm
- ransomware
- trojan
- spyware
- adware

▼ Write down function of three malware types

[6 marks]

Virus	self-replicating software that is designed to harm the computer by draining computing power/deletes files
Worm	self-replicating software that functions the same as virus but it does not need host file or human interactions to spread
Ransomware	encrypts/locks the user files and demands a payment to decrypt/unlock it back
Spyware	spys/monitors the screen to steal personal/sensitive/confidential information

▼ Function of firewall

[2 marks]

Monitors ingoing and outgoing data traffic deciding which data to be allowed to pass through according to a set of rules known as firewall policy

▼ List two ways to improve physical security

[2 marks]

- CCTVs
- electronic locks
- biometric systems
- security guards
- alarm systems
- laser

▼ Define eavesdropping

[2 marks]

process of intercepting or sniffing data traffic to steal personal/sensitive/confidential information

▼ State how to protect from eavesdropping

[2 marks]

- encryption
- using VPNs

▼ List two features of a strong password

[2 marks]

- at least 12 characters or more
- mixed up with numbers, upper cases, lower cases and special symbols
- uncommon/unique words

▼ Define audit trail

[1 marks]

a detail record that keeps activity logs that contain who did changes, when happened and what changed

▼ Write down the purpose of audit trailing

[1 marks]

to detect/find/analyze any suspicious activity that tries to get unauthorized access

▼ Define modular testing

[1 marks]

to ensure each section/part is working accurately by testing

▼ Define penetration testing

[1 marks]

process that is performed by ethical hackers for the sake of finding and fixing security vulnerabilities before getting exploited by hackers

▼ Define two-factor authentication (2FA)

[1 marks]

an authentication method that sends one-time security code (usually PIN) to authentication app or device

▼ Define access control

[1 marks]

the ability to perform something with the data. For instance, modify, edit and copy.

▼ State the purpose of managing access control

[1 marks]

To limit/prevent unauthorized access

▼ List at least two examples of software vulnerabilities

[2 marks]

- program bugs
- program crashes
- security vulnerabilities

▼ Explain why the delay of not updating software to latest version could pose a threat to the security of the network

[2 marks]

One method

- compromised/unpatched software is more vulnerable to attack (1)
- and may allow an attacker control of the whole network (1)

Another method

- unpatched software has known weaknesses (1)
- which can be exploited by a hacker (1)

▼ Describe how an email phishing attack targeting bank customers might work

One way

- The victim opens the unknown links given by attackers
- and fill in the confidential information which attackers can use.

Another way

- An attacker will claim to be from a part of larger organization aiming to fix the issues from victim computer
- Victim will follow through attacker's steps and give out the confidential information.

▼ Discuss the methods Santiago can use to find and fix network vulnerabilities.

Consider

- Ethical Hacking
- Commercial analysis tools
- Review of network and user policies

Ethical hacking

- Ethical hackers are white hat hackers
- Attempt to access the network as a hacker does
- Don't attempt to change or steal data
- Looking for weaknesses in the network
- Weakness pointed out
- Weaknesses fixed
- Could be employed by the business
- Could work for another specialist company
- Can include penetration testing

Commercial analysis tools

- Software used to find weaknesses
- Can be configured to check for a range of weaknesses
- Results/reports generated identifying faults
- Weaknesses fixed

Review of network and user policies

- Collection of rules and guidelines that govern the behaviours of network devices/users
- Need reviewing because may not comply with new laws and regulations
- Reviews should be scheduled

▼ How do you access the web pages on internet?

[4 marks]

- First user has to enter a URL of the website
- Domain name from URL has to be checked with DNS to find IP address
- Web browser connects to web server using IP address found from DNS
- A web page is transferred using HTTP(s) protocol
- Web browser displayed the web page described by HTML

▼ Describe the difference between the Internet and the World Wide Web.

Internet

- The internet is a global network of networks
- The internet is the most well known WAN (Wide Area Network)
- The internet is a infrastructure used to provide connectivity to WWW

World Wide Web

- Collection of websites and web pages that are accessed using internet
- Web pages are accessed using a web browser, which communicates with web servers to retrieve and display the content.

▼ How many bits do IPv4 and IPv6 use for each address?

[2 marks]

- IPv4 – 32 bits
- IPv6 – 128 bits

▼ Why does IPv6 uses 128 bits?

[2 marks]

- IPv6 has 8 group of 4 hexadecimal digits
- Each hexadecimal can represented using 4 bits
- since they are in 4 hexadecimal digits, each group can be represented using 16 bits
- It has total of 8 groups thus, 128 bits

▼ Explain why IPv6 addressing was introduced.

[2 marks]

- IPv4 addresses are running out
- IPv6 can represent more devices using 128 bits per address compared to 32 bits per address

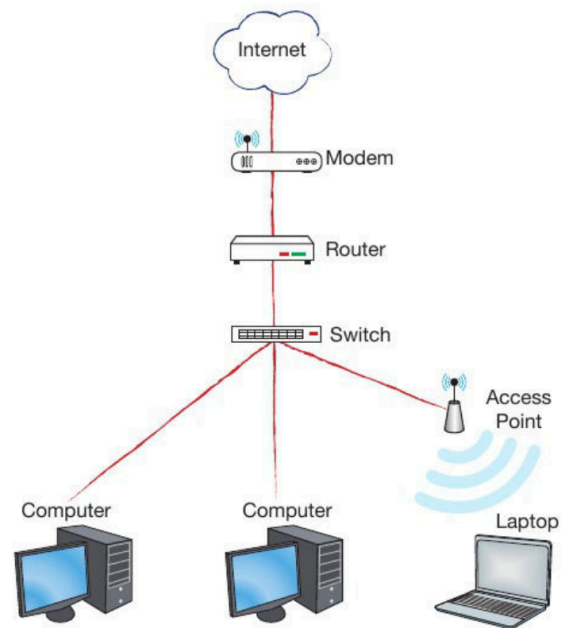
▼ What are the role of a switch, WAP, router and a modem in a network?

[4 marks]

- A switch connects multiple devices (computers, printers, etc.) to a single network, allowing them to communicate with each other. It operates at the data link layer, forwarding data packets based on MAC addresses.
- The router manages the flow of data between your devices and the internet, assigning IP addresses and routing traffic appropriately. It ensures that data is sent to the right devices and destinations.
- The WAP extends the network's reach by enabling wireless devices to connect to the network. It acts as a "hub" for wireless communication, allowing devices like smartphones and laptops to connect without the need for wired connections.
- The modem acts as the gateway between your home network and the internet, converting digital signals into analog signals for transmission and back. It's essentially the device that connects your network to your Internet Service Provider (ISP).

▼ Draw a diagram connecting how computer gets access to internet [6 marks]

► **Figure 5.10** Devices allowing network users to connect to the Internet

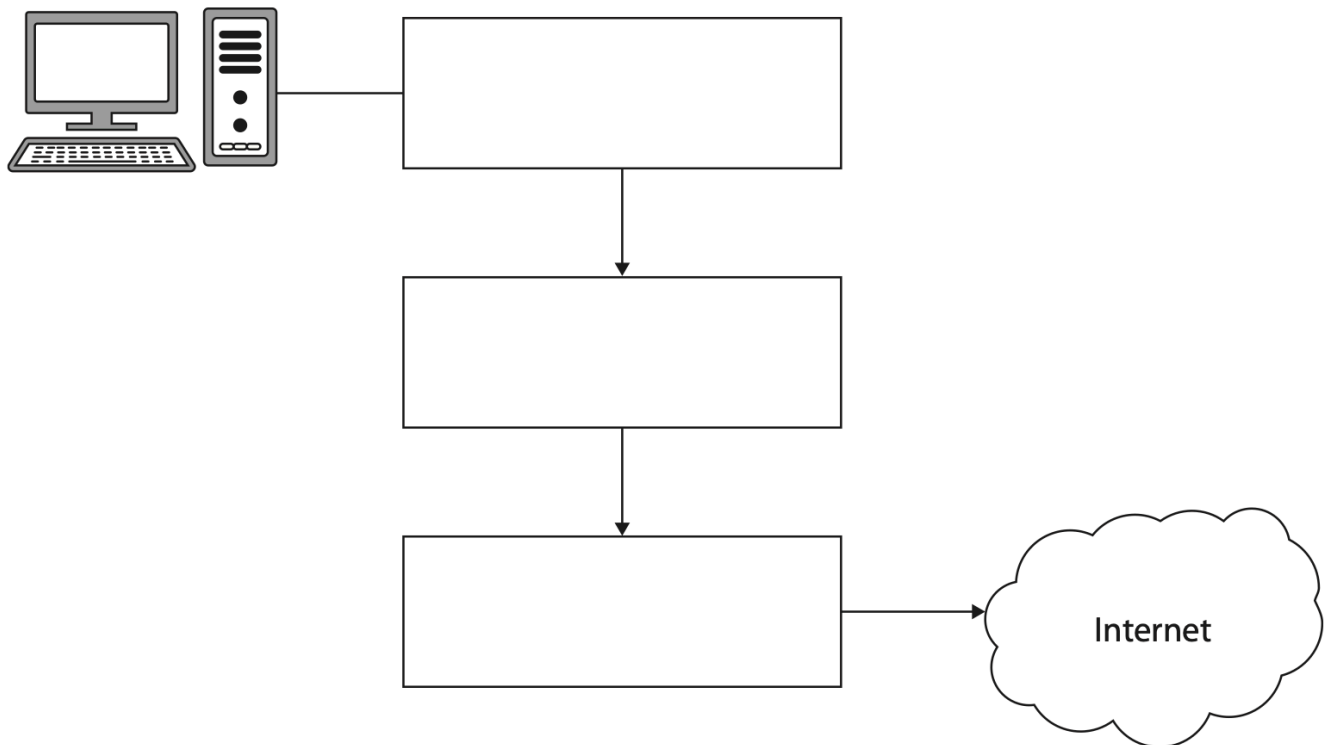


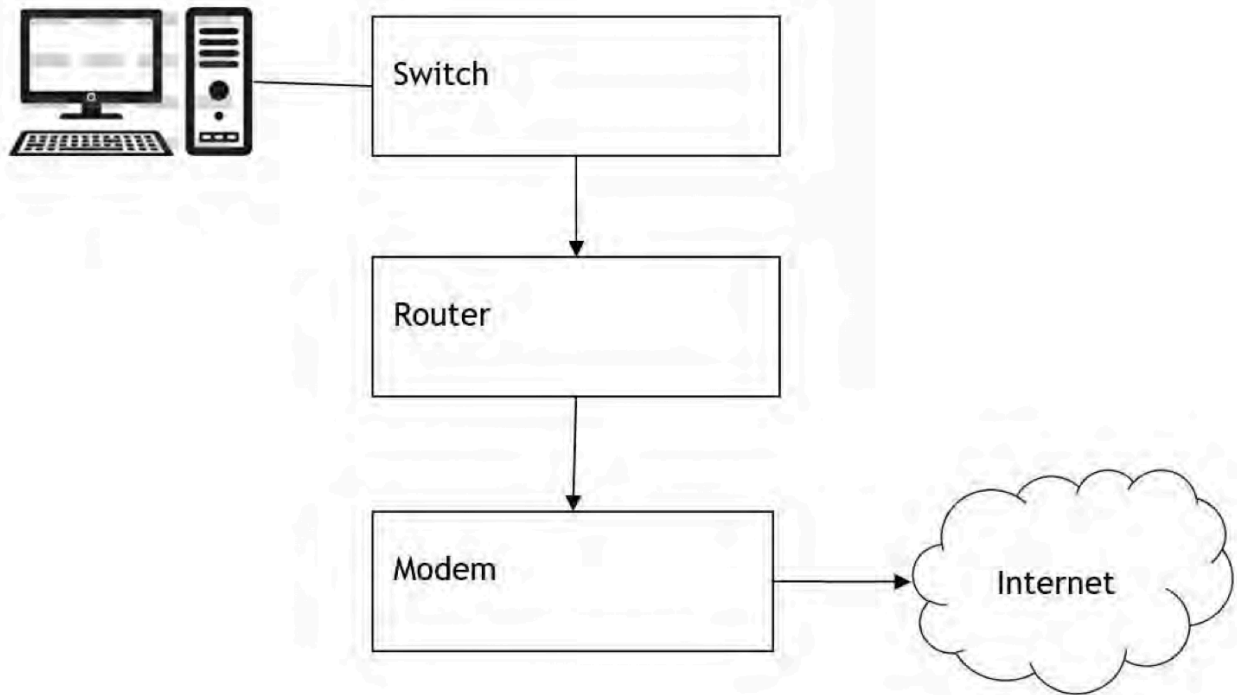
(d) A single physical box connects a desktop computer to the Internet.

The box incorporates three different components.

Complete the diagram to show the names of the components in the correct order.

(3)





Topic 6: The Bigger Picture

Chapter 24: Computing And The Environmental impact of Technology

▼ List at least two disadvantages of computer technology on the environment

- high energy consumption leading to climate change/global warming as non-renewable/fossil fuels are being used to generate electricity
- landfills due to e-waste causing pollutions (water/air)
- material shortages as excessive amount of it are being used for manufacturing digital devices

▼ List two positive impacts of using technology on the environment [2 marks]

- Tracking endangered animals using GPS trackers
- Warning systems to alert approaching tsunamis
- Measuring sea surface temperatures to learn more about climate change
- Using sensors to turn off wasteful electrical resources

▼ List two ways to reduce energy consumption [2 marks]

- implementing automative lighting systems to reduce unnecessary/wasteful electricity usage
- choosing digital devices that has a low energy consumption rate/high energy efficiency rate
- replacing energy efficient materials in manufacturing digital devices

▼ List two ways in which landfills can be harmful for human health [2 marks]

- contribute water/air pollutions due to toxic/radioactive materials
- can cause chemical leak into the soil affecting near plants

▼ List two positive impacts of using technology on the environment [2 marks]

- Tracking endangered animals using GPS trackers
- Warning systems to alert approaching tsunamis
- Measuring sea surface temperatures to learn more about climate change
- Using sensors to turn off wasteful electrical resources

▼ Discuss the positive and negative effects of computer science technology on the environment [6 marks]

- **Energy:** Manufacture and use of devices uses energy. Manufacturing involves energy-intensive mining and processing of minerals. The use of devices involves the energy used by the devices themselves, but also by data centres. These data centres generate heat, so energy is needed to keep them cool. Much of the energy used comes from non-renewable sources such as gas and coal. Computer science is used in efficient energy production. Computer software is used to design, model and test efficient devices to produce electricity from wind, wave and solar power. Energy use can be reduced using smart technologies, such as light-sensitive switches that turn off lights when they are not needed. Efficient transport planning using computer modelling and analysis can reduce fuel use.
- **Sustainability:** Digital devices use many different chemical elements. Some of these are rare and will be in short supply as they are used up. It is difficult to recycle devices to reuse these elements.
- **Waste:** Electronic devices are difficult to recycle and are often disposed of in landfill sites as e-waste. Landfill sites take up areas of land that could be used for other purposes. Toxic substances such as lead, mercury and cobalt can get into the soil and the water supply from the landfill sites and so cause health problems.
- **Data analysis:** Computer science technology can be used to monitor environmental factors by transmitting and analysing data. This data can be shared by scientists around the world who can collaborate to find solutions to problems. Computers can be used to develop models to forecast environmental behaviour and identify options for action.

▼ Explain why cloud storage companies often locate their servers in cold countries to protect the environment [3 marks]

To reduce electricity usage (1) because servers generate lots of heat (1), which would otherwise require air conditioners (1) that can be replaced with natural cooling system (1).

Chapter 25: Privacy

▼ List two privacy enhancing tools

[2 marks]

- Encryption
- Password manager
- VPN (Virtual Private Network)
- Privacy-enhanced browsers (Brave, Firefox)
- Cookies cleaner
- Private browsing mode, incognito mode
- Trackers blockers

▼ List two benefits of giving away personal information

[2 marks]

- Personalized experience
- Faster user experiences due to autofill forms

▼ List two benefits of analyzing Big Data

[2 marks]

- Identify side effects of drug
- Recommending good resources to users that align with their interests
- Notify the spread of diseases
- Governments use Big Data to monitor traffic flows, energy usage, or public transport needs to improve urban planning

▼ State why it is important to protect personal information

- Could fall into identify theft
- which they can use our details to imitate behaviours of us to manipulate others.

Chapter 26: Digital Inclusion

▼ Define Digital Divide

[1 mark]

The gap between technology-empowered people and technology-excluded people

▼ List two benefits of being digitally included

[2 marks]

- More job opportunities
- Access to online information and resources
- Social interactions and communication

▼ List two disadvantages of being digitally excluded

[2 marks]

- Less job opportunities
- Limited to online information and resources
- Less social interaction and communication

▼ List two things that contribute to digital inclusion

[2 marks]

- Not being able to access the internet
- Poor landline infrastructure
- Lack of knowledge or skills
- Privacy concerns
- Not being able to afford

▼ List two ways to reduce digital inclusion

[2 marks]

- Building more infrastructure to promote internet access
- Offering more budget-friendly internet plans
- Providing public wi-fi areas
- Giving free tech training programs

Chapter 27: Professionalism

▼ Define professionalism

[1 mark]

The skills and competence expected of a person in a professional setting

▼ List two ways that computer scientists can demonstrate professionalism

- Belong to/have membership in a professional society (1)
- Attend computer science related conferences/gatherings (1)
- Attaining/gaining training/educational opportunities (1)
- Behave in ethical/legal/moral ways (1)
- Stay up to date with changes in the field/read up-to-date publications (1)
- Use responsible programming practices e.g. due diligence/testing/commenting code for maintainability (1)
- Avoid bias when making design choices (1)

▼ Airtest produces exhaust emissions testing software. A programmer discovers that there is a bug in the software that produces inaccurate results under particular circumstances. Discuss What course of action the programmer should take and explain why. [4 marks]

The BCS Code of Conduct for computer scientists stipulates that they should not withhold information on the performance of systems. Therefore, the programmer should inform their manager immediately. Furthermore, the code also states that they must avoid injuring others. If the testing software is producing faulty information about exhaust emissions it could also endanger human health, which is another reason for the programmer to take action to flag up the problem.

Chapter 28: Computing And The Legal Impact Of Technology

▼ Define intellectual property

[1 mark]

An unique humankind creation that has a commercial value

▼ List two ways to protect intellectual property

[2 marks]

- Copyright
- Patent

▼ Assess the extent to which the patent system is a barrier to the technological innovation.

[4 marks]

A patent gives the patent holder the exclusive right for 20 years to make, use and sell an invention. This encourages inventiveness by ensuring that the owner of the patent (usually the employer of the inventors) gets recognition and benefits financially from the invention. However, in recent years, big companies such as Apple and Samsung have been embroiled in long and expensive legal battles over alleged patent infringements. To defend a patent is very costly. There is an argument that the money spent on legal fees would be better invested in research and development. Patent law encourages companies to keep new inventions secret and block others from using them for 20 years. If inventions were shared from the outset, the pace of technological progress and innovation would be accelerated.

▼ Difference the main between copyright and patent

[2 marks]

Copyright only protects the expression of the product whereas patent protects the idea or design of the product

▼ Define proprietary software

[1 mark]

Non-free software that restricts access of the source code

▼ Define open-source software

[1 mark]

Free software that let user to modify, contribute, and distribute.

▼ List two benefits of proprietary software

[2 marks]

- Available technical support
- Better security
- More user-friendly

▼ List two benefits of open-source software

[2 marks]

- Highly customizable
- Free

▼ Difference between proprietary software and open-source software [2 marks]

- Open source software is free and able to edit and redistribute
- Proprietary software belongs to an individual or a company. Its license specifies that users aren't allowed to modify source code

▼ Provide two reasons why a content creator would considering using a Creative Commons license to make their work available to others [2 marks]

- To give the public permission to share and use their work.
- To allow others to modify and change the original work.

Chapter 29: Current and Emerging Trends

▼ Describe what is meant by Artificial Intelligence [2 marks]

The ability of a digital computer or computer-controlled robot to perform tasks commonly associated with intelligent beings. Intelligent beings are those that can adapt to changing circumstances.

▼ Describe what is meant by Machine Learning [2 marks]

Machine learning is a form of artificial intelligence (AI) that allows computer systems to carry out complex processes by learning from data, rather than following pre-programmed rules.

▼ What is DNA? [1 mark]

DNA is the material that stores genetic information in all organisms.

▼ Describe differences between normal computer and DNA computers [2 marks]

- DNA computers use DNA rather than silicon like normal computers. DNA doesn't use two bits but four bits (A, T, G and C). Normal computers use binary which is two bits (0 and 1).
- Like modern storage devices, DNA is digital, but it is not binary. Binary encoding uses two bits (0 and 1) but DNA uses four possible bits named adenine (A), thymine (T), guanine (G) and cytosine (C) after their chemical structure.

▼ Describe the advantages of DNA computers over normal ones [2 marks]

- There will always be supply of DNA
- The large supply of DNA makes it cheap resource
- DNA biochips can be made cleanly unlike toxic materials used to make traditional processors
- DNA computers are many times smaller than today's computers.

▼ Why is DNA suitable for storing data? [2 marks]

Because DNA consists of 4 digits which are arranged in groups of 3, it can encode information represented by the bits and bytes of computer systems.

▼ Define what is meant by nanotechnology [1 mark]

The manipulation of matter with a size of from 1 to 100 nanometres.

▼ Describe a place where nanotechnology is used.

[1 mark]

- Self cleaning windows
- Clothing
- Scratch-Resistant coating
- Medicine

▼ What is meant by quantum computing

[2 marks]

Quantum computing is based on quantum mechanics. Quantum mechanics is the branch of physics that describes the behaviour of very small subatomic particles, which can exist as both particles and waves. Quantum computers use qubits, which can represent both 1 and 0 at the same time.

▼ Define the term superposition

[1 mark]

The ability of a quantum system to be in multiple states at the same time until it is measured.

▼ Define the term entanglement

[1 mark]

Co-dependence of the quantum states of pairs or groups of particles.

▼ Define the term qubit

[1 mark]

A quantum bit, the counterpart in quantum computing to the binary digit or bit of classical computing.

▼ How can quantum computers solve complex arithmetic problems far more rapidly than classical computers?

[2 marks]

Each qubit can be 1 and 0 at the same time and so can calculate a vast number of possible outcomes simultaneously.

▼ How can quantum computers solve complex arithmetic problems far more rapidly than classical computers?

[2 marks]

Each qubit can be 1 and 0 at the same time and so can calculate a vast number of possible outcomes simultaneously.

▼ Describe how artificial intelligence could identify what is wrong with patients by symptoms. [2 marks]

- It will interpret/analyse patient input to identify symptoms (1) and match the symptoms to (possible) illnesses (1)
- It will match symptoms to possible illnesses (1) and give the most likely/probable illness (1)
- It will match symptoms to possible illnesses (1) and ask further questions to narrow it down (1)
- It will match symptoms to possible illnesses (1) by searching/using a database/other data store (1)

© 2025 Ozzy

Contributions are welcome!

[Submit a pull request on GitHub or contact me directly.](#)